

Not how many. Which skills, where, and why.

What official data says about migration, skills and housing in Australia. Data to March 2026.

292,137

net overseas migration, the year to March 2026; down 47% from the record

Official data

23.2%

of net overseas migration came on skilled visas, 2024-25

Official data

1.2m

people separate the plans by June 2030

Our estimate

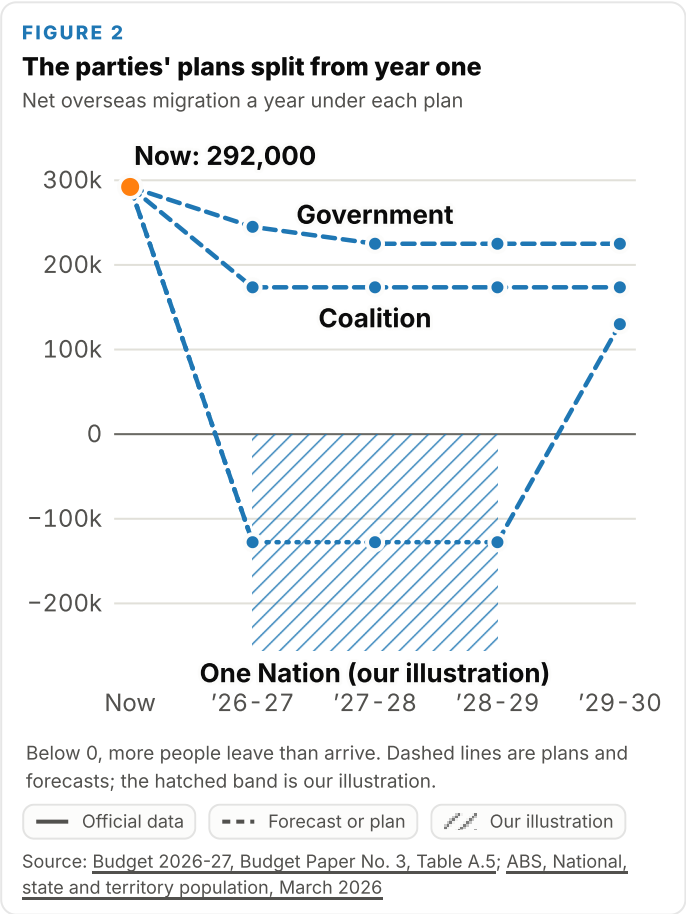
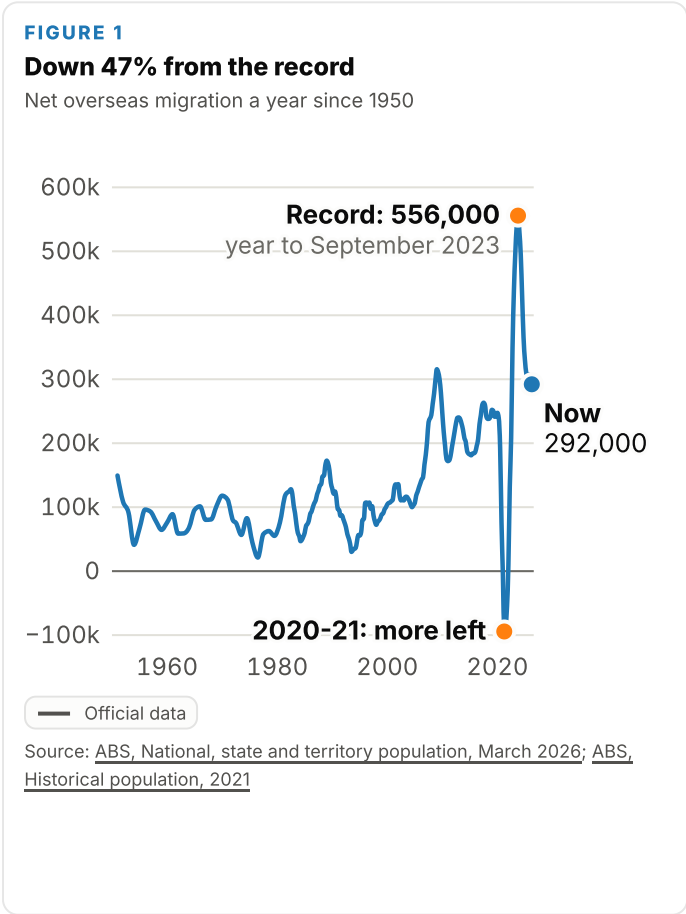
118,000

homes short of population growth since 2022

Our estimate

WHAT THE DATA SAYS

1. Net overseas migration is **292,137** a year, down 47% from the record in the year to September 2023.
2. Temporary visas outnumber permanent ones **4 to 1** among arrivals; 7 in 100 arrivals held a permanent skilled visa.
3. Skilled visas made up **23.2%** of net migration in 2024-25; students added 108,000, more than all skilled visas combined.
4. By June 2030 the parties' plans end **1.2 million people** apart.
5. Today's building outpaces every plan's needs, but the country is about **118,000 homes behind** since 2022.
6. Doctors, mechanics, nurses and child care: about **9 in 10 jobs short**.



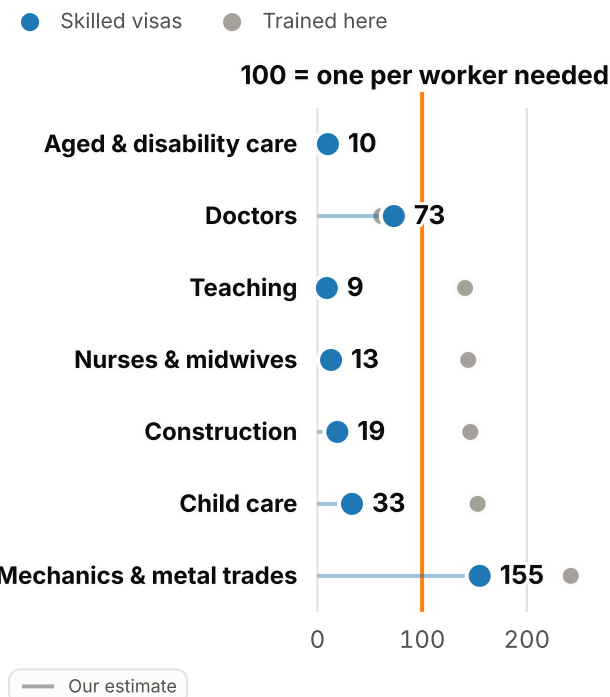
LIMITS

- Forecasts and projections can be wrong; official migration figures are revised as more travel records arrive.
- Skilled visas are a small share of all arrivals, and people can change jobs after they arrive.
- The scenario model and simulator are simple arithmetic with no feedback from the economy; they are illustrations, not forecasts.
- One Nation gave no size for its net-negative years, so that range is our illustration from the party's own figures.

FIGURE 3

Aged care: 7 trained and 10 skilled visas per 100 needed

Temporary skilled visas (blue) and people trained here (grey) per 100 workers needed a year



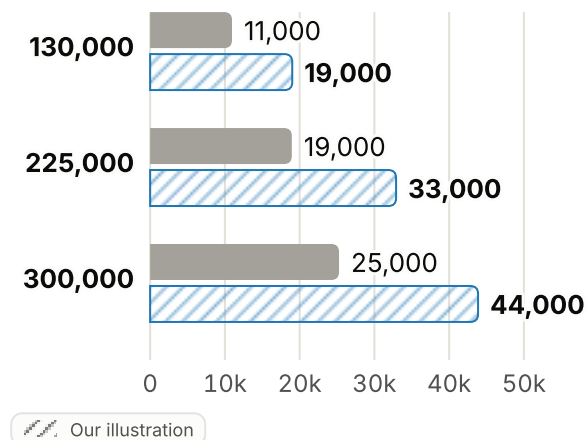
Source: Home Affairs, Temporary resident (skilled) visas, BP0014, to 30 June 2026; Jobs and Skills Australia, Employment projections, May 2025 to May 2035; NCVER, Apprentices and trainees (DataBuilder); Department of Education, 2024 award course completions; Jobs and Skills Australia, Employment projections, May 2025 to May 2035

FIGURE 4

Mix matters as much as size

Skilled workers a year reaching jobs on the shortage list, by size of net overseas migration

Today's mix Skills-first (our illustration)



Source: ABS, Overseas migration, 2024-25; ABS, Migrant settlement outcomes, 2026 (Census 2021 linked data); Home Affairs, Temporary resident (skilled) visas, BP0014, to 30 June 2026; Jobs and Skills Australia, 2025 Occupation Shortage List; Jobs and Skills Australia, Employment projections, May 2025 to May 2035

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR SKILLED MIGRATION PLANNING

- **Size and skill are separate levers.** About 58% of temporary skilled visas go to jobs on the shortage list. In our illustration, aiming every skilled place at short jobs sends about 33,000 skilled workers a year to them at 225,000, against 25,000 at 300,000 with today's mix.
- **The gaps are specific.** Aged care has the largest gap we can measure: 7 trained here and 10 skilled visas for every 100 workers needed a year.
- **Housing is a shared constraint.** The population has grown faster than homes were finished since the March quarter 2022: about 118,000 homes behind, whichever plan is chosen next.
- **Skilled migrants mostly work.** 82 in 100 skilled visa migrants aged 15 to 64 have a job, against 74 in 100 overall (Census 2021). This measures any job, not the job they were selected for.

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